

Airbnb | Forecast the guide, test the composition

Status: UNSIGNED | ABNB, Nasdaq Class A | USD | As of 2026-09-13; operating inputs 2026-09-11, consensus dates below. Fixed 2/3 K0 BENCHMARK; conversion-dependent claims are provisional pending L3 validation. FX/RNPL integration is separately pending. Direction, target and probabilities remain open.

The benchmark operating review implies a Q4 guide of \$3,123M, \$37.6M (1.19%) below captured LSEG-family revenue consensus. The same revenue at the inherited Q4 cushion implies \$3,061M. This is conditional arithmetic; it does not establish a trading edge. [R]

Operating inputs reach revenue with a lag

The review uses $146.8\text{M Q3 nights} \times \$177.17 \text{ ADR} = \$26.0086\text{bn GBV}$. Revenue = $\lambda \times [(2/3) \text{ prior-quarter GBV} + (1/3) \text{ second-prior GBV}]$; guide = revenue / (1 + cushion). Imported Q4 λ is 12.04037% and the trailing-eight median cushion is 1.79049%. Dollar contribution shares are 65.66% / 34.34%, not literal 2/3 and 1/3 revenue shares. Q3 nights affect Q4 revenue; Q4 nights first affect Q1 2027. [R]

Main exhibit | Q4 guide and cushion sensitivity

Conditional case	Q3 GBV \$bn	Q4 revenue \$m	Q4 guide \$m	Gap to LSEG \$m
ADR v3 with-K / review	26.009	3,179.3	3,123.4	-37.6
ADR v3 without-K	25.966	3,175.9	3,120.1	-41.0
ADR residual reversion	25.392	3,129.9	3,074.8	-86.2
K0 conditional ledger	26.450	3,214.8	3,158.2	-2.8
Review / mean cushion	26.009	3,179.3	3,121.4	-39.6
Review / legacy cushion	26.009	3,179.3	3,060.6	-100.4

Notes: LSEG-family \$3,161.021M, 2026-09-13T15:20Z; S&P \$3,160M, 2026-09-10; Zacks \$3,200M, 2026-09-11. Yahoo/Alpha Vantage relays count as one LSEG-family panel. These are revenue consensus comparators, not explicit management-guide consensus. All rows are scenarios, not probability intervals. [R]

The older \$3,059.4M H2-v3 guide reconciles to K0's \$3,158.2M: changing Q3 GBV adds \$32.58M, λ \$2.72M, and the cushion \$63.53M in that order. The review uses its own ADRv3 operating block; numbers were not selected for their sign versus Street. [R]

FX integration remains unresolved. USD GBV already contains booking-period FX. L3 must supply verified cohort/currency weights and recognition timing before replacing the relevant FX component once. RNPL remains in total exposure; payment, FX fixing and recognition are distinct dates. No full FX factor or assumed zero hedge line is added. ADRv3's Q3 -0.43pp / Q4 +0.15pp ADR FX is already embedded and is not the revenue-FX contribution. [R, F]

Sources: [R] L4 revenue snapshot: forecast, operating_inputs, guide_reconciliation, sensitivity and consensus_comparison CSVs; [M] L4 model snapshot: scenario_summary, annual and valuation CSVs. Exact paths, information dates and SHA-256 hashes accompany this memo.

Valuation is conditional; adoption is open

The review financial path produces \$184.66/share at 16.5x FY27 adjusted EBITDA. This uses FY27-end cash and diluted shares, a 31 December 2027 convention; it is not an adopted target. FY27 beyond the kernel-covered quarters inherits the model's growth, cost, cash and share assumptions. The +/-1% rows below test incremental revenue sensitivity; they are not L3 FX estimates or probability bounds. [M]

Conditional case	FY27 rev \$bn	Adj. EBITDA \$bn	FCF \$bn	Value \$/share
Operating review	15.952	5.808	5.537	184.66
K0 conditional ledger	16.058	5.888	5.612	187.13
-1% revenue sensitivity	15.833	5.688	5.423	180.89
+1% revenue sensitivity	16.071	5.927	5.651	188.43

Notes: +/-1% applies to covered Q3/Q4 2026 and Q1 2027 revenue. FY27 Q3/Q4 inherit growth on the changed 2026 base; Q2 is unchanged. FCF = adjusted EBITDA + net interest - cash taxes + change in unearned fees + working-capital residual - capex. Review FY27 cash taxes are \$542.4M, capex \$47.9M; FCF after deducting SBC is \$3,571.6M. These cash-flow assumptions are inherited. [M]

Reference per-share value = $(16.5 \times \$5,807.5\text{M EBITDA} + \$10,282.6\text{M net cash}) / 574.598\text{M shares}$: EV \$95,824.3M; equity \$106,106.9M. Legacy arithmetic reproduces \$180.88 for its EBITDA lens versus \$156.79 for its six-lens mean, with an approximate September-2027 label using year-end balances. These are distinct objects. The unvalidated +0.48 growth/multiple relation is excluded. [M, V]

Opposing evidence limits the conviction

A2 is PARTIAL: at letter-close vintages it matched guide-gap signs in 7/8 W1 and 6/7 W2 strong cases, but executable aligned 20-day excess returns averaged -0.308/-0.983pp; intervals cross zero. B2 FAILS its 70% revision hurdle (5/9 and 4/7); its unseasonal compounded-GBV LIVE values are excluded here. W2 is nested in W1. These findings cannot establish an actionable expectations edge. [E]

ADRV3's residual-carry rule passes its dollar target on $n=10/9$ windows, distinct from the main $n=14/10$ harness; its integer-fair ex-FX target does not pass both windows. Selection was post-hoc; the binding without-K jackknife margin is 0.011. Its 4.85pp residual remains unobserved. Reversion gives a \$3,075M Q4 guide versus \$3,158M for stronger K0 GBV, without assigned probabilities. [A, R]

What would change the conclusion

At the November print, score conversion using $100 \times \text{Q3 revenue} / 27,866.666667$: warn below 17.09% and escalate below 16.93%, with whole-million rounding intervals. F's proposed refutation requires all three: lambda wholly at least 17.09%; UF growth less GBV growth wholly above -8pp; and explicit Q4 nights guidance of low double digit or stronger. Missing or crossing evidence remains absent/inconclusive. This is an unsigned condition, not a trade instruction or RNPL causal test. [F]

F's corrected stock history is 2.0/8.0/9.7pp; migration and RNPL revenue-cohort shares remain unidentified. The October 2 submission precedes the project-calendar November 5 catalyst and October 22-24 finals. Accepted L3 conversion and FX/RNPL inputs may change these provisional values. [F, R]

Sources: [A] docs/adrv3/SYNTHESIS.md (11 Sep 2026); [E] LANE2_MEMO_READY_CLAIMS.md (13 Sep); [F] ALPHA_F_RNPL.md and D_CARD_ADDENDUM_LAMBDA.md (13/12 Sep); [V] LANE1_MEMO_READY_CLAIMS_v2.md (13 Sep). [R/M] exact snapshot paths and SHA-256 ledger accompany the editable source. Evidence base: commit 1c87628cedbc94ab8a0e8552743c94485ef353b8. Scenario values carry no expected-return or probability claim.